

TEMPLATE P08 · VALUE HYPOTHESIS CANVAS

# Value hypothesis canvas

Formulates the initiative's expected value as a falsifiable, measurable hypothesis expressed in money, with its attribution method and stop criteria set before investing.

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## 01

# Instructions for use

| Aspect                       | Guidance                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it is used              | In phase 2 (Value hypothesis), before G2. It is compared with the pilot results in phase 5 (P22) and with the value realised in phases 6 and 7 (P28). |
| Who completes it             | The AI Product Owner. Management control reviews the unit values and the formula.                                                                     |
| Who verifies it              | Lite: AI Office. Enterprise: AI Auditor.                                                                                                              |
| Who decides                  | Lite: sponsor. Enterprise: AI Committee. Transform: in addition, the board or its board committee.                                                    |
| Gate at which it is reviewed | G2 · Hypothesis.                                                                                                                                      |

| Aspect                        | Guidance                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tool</b>                   | T11 · Value hypothesis canvas and calculator.                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Lite versus Enterprise</b> | Lite may omit the fields marked <b>(Enterprise)</b> . The hypothesis, main metric, baseline, threshold, attribution method, formula and stop criteria are mandatory in both. |

Rules that apply (00 §6):

- Every amount has a **formula** (units × unit value), is **incremental** relative to the baseline and has a **status**: validated, declared or estimated.
- **Efficiencies, return** and **recurring cost** are kept separate. **Annual net value = efficiencies + return – recurring cost**.
- **Released capacity does not count** until it is realised or explicitly reassigned.
- Each euro is attributed to a **single case**; if there are shared outcomes, the allocation is declared.
- **A hypothesis that cannot fail is not valid**. The stop criteria may not be relaxed afterwards without the approval of the body that authorised the initiative (01 §7.4).

The figures in the examples are **fictitious**.

## 02

# Identification

| Field                           | Content | Guidance                                                |
|---------------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Initiative code</b>          |         | IA-AAAA-NNN.                                            |
| <b>Initiative name</b>          |         |                                                         |
| <b>Confirmed ambition level</b> |         | Optimise · Augment · Transform (P07, Confirmed column). |
| <b>Primary sphere</b>           |         | Taxonomy in 03 §3.3.                                    |
| <b>Intensity</b>                |         | Lite · Enterprise.                                      |
| <b>Document version</b>         |         |                                                         |
| <b>Date</b>                     |         | DD-MM-AAAA.                                             |
| <b>Author</b>                   |         | Name and role.                                          |

## Problem, users and solution

| Field                      | Content | Guidance                                                     |
|----------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Understandable description |         | What it is and what it is used for (rule 10).                |
| Problem or opportunity     |         | Current situation with baseline data (P09).                  |
| Users and beneficiaries    |         | Who uses the system and who receives the benefit.            |
| Proposed solution          |         | What the system will do and what people will continue to do. |
| Critical assumptions       |         | Conditions without which the hypothesis does not hold.       |

## Falsifiable value hypothesis

**Format:** *If [intervention], then [main metric] will move from [baseline] to [target] in [scope] within [timeframe], measured with [attribution method]. The hypothesis will be considered refuted if [measurable condition].*

| Field                | Content | Guidance                                                    |
|----------------------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hypothesis statement |         | A single sentence in the format above.                      |
| Refutation condition |         | Specific result that would show the hypothesis to be false. |
| Testing horizon      |         | Date or period in which it will be tested.                  |

*(illustrative example)* If a response assistant is introduced for order queries in the web channel, then the rate of queries resolved without the intervention of an agent will move from 0% to 35% in that channel within six months of the start of the pilot, measured with a control group. The hypothesis will be considered refuted if the rate is below 20% or if the satisfaction of the customers served falls by more than 5 points relative to the control group.

Falsifiability test:

| Question                                                                | Yes · No |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Is there a possible result that would refute the hypothesis?            |          |
| Are the metric, threshold, scope and timeframe numerical or verifiable? |          |
| Is the baseline measured or is its estimate justified (P09)?            |          |

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# Metrics

| Type                             | Metric                              | Definition and formula                                             | Unit   | Baseline (P09) | Target | Success threshold | Frequency |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------------|--------|-------------------|-----------|
| Main                             |                                     |                                                                    |        |                |        |                   |           |
| Secondary                        |                                     |                                                                    |        |                |        |                   |           |
| Safeguard                        |                                     |                                                                    |        |                |        |                   |           |
| (illustrative example) Main      | Resolution rate without an agent    | Queries closed without handover ÷ queries handled by the assistant | %      | 0%             | 35%    | 20%               | Weekly    |
| (illustrative example) Safeguard | Satisfaction of the customer served | Average of the follow-up survey (0–100)                            | points | 78             | ≥ 78   | ≥ 73              | Weekly    |

- **Target:** expected result.
- **Success threshold:** minimum for the hypothesis to be considered validated.
- **Safeguard metric:** what must not get worse (quality, satisfaction, errors, complaints, fairness).

## Attribution method

| Field                                    | Content | Guidance                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Method</b>                            |         | Control group · Before and after · Other, justified. A control group is preferred whenever possible.         |
| <b>Design</b>                            |         | How the groups or periods are formed, size and duration.                                                     |
| <b>Threats to validity</b>               |         | Seasonality, simultaneous changes in the process, novelty effect, selection of favourable cases.             |
| <b>How they are controlled</b>           |         | Measures to neutralise each threat.                                                                          |
| <b>Who validates the measurement</b>     |         | Management control or audit (condition for <i>validated</i> status).                                         |
| <b>Allocation with other initiatives</b> |         | If another initiative contributes to the same outcome, percentage attributed to each and criterion (rule 5). |

## Value in money

### 7.1 Annual amounts

| Type                  | Item | Units | Unit value (€) and source | Formula | Annual amount (€) | Amount status                          | Assumptions |
|-----------------------|------|-------|---------------------------|---------|-------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Efficiencies</b>   |      |       |                           |         |                   | validated ·<br>declared ·<br>estimated |             |
| <b>Return</b>         |      |       |                           |         |                   |                                        |             |
| <b>Recurring cost</b> |      |       |                           |         |                   |                                        |             |

| Type                                                   | Item                                                 | Units           | Unit value (€) and source   | Formula               | Annual amount (€) | Amount status | Assumptions                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>(illustrative example)</i><br><b>Efficiencies</b>   | External customer service hours no longer contracted | 4,000 h         | €21.00/h (current contract) | $4,000 \times 21.00$  | 84,000            | estimated     | Contractual reduction agreed with the supplier from the second quarter. |
| <i>(illustrative example)</i><br><b>Return</b>         | Orders not cancelled thanks to an immediate response | 1,200 orders    | €9.00 margin per order      | $1,200 \times 9.00$   | 10,800            | estimated     | Cancellation rate of the control group.                                 |
| <i>(illustrative example)</i><br><b>Recurring cost</b> | Model consumption                                    | 200,000 queries | €0.03 per query             | $200,000 \times 0.03$ | 6,000             | estimated     | Supplier's public rate.                                                 |
| <i>(illustrative example)</i><br><b>Recurring cost</b> | Platform licences                                    | 1               | €12,000 per year            | $1 \times 12,000$     | 12,000            | estimated     | Offer received.                                                         |
| <i>(illustrative example)</i><br><b>Recurring cost</b> | Operations staff                                     | 0.3 FTE         | €55,000 per FTE             | $0.3 \times 55,000$   | 16,500            | estimated     | Average cost of the function.                                           |

## 7.2 Economic summary

| Item                                  | Amount (€) | Guidance                                                               |
|---------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Efficiencies</b>                   |            | Sum from 7.1.                                                          |
| <b>Return</b>                         |            | Sum from 7.1.                                                          |
| <b>Recurring cost</b>                 |            | Sum from 7.1.                                                          |
| <b>Annual net value</b>               |            | Efficiencies + return – recurring cost.                                |
| <b>Additional investment required</b> |            | Build, integration, adoption and control up to production.             |
| <b>Additional net value per euro</b>  |            | Expected additional annual net value ÷ additional investment required. |

| Item                                  | Amount (€) | Guidance                                            |
|---------------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Time to first value                   |            | Months.                                             |
| Return horizon set in C2 (Enterprise) |            | Period within which the net value must be positive. |

(illustrative example)  $84,000 + 10,800 - 34,500 = \text{€}60,300$  of annual net value. With an additional investment of €90,000, the additional net value per euro is  $60,300 \div 90,000 = \mathbf{0.67}$ .

### 7.3 Released capacity (does not count)

| Capacity                                    | Quantity     | Realisation or reassignment plan                                                      | Owner                       | Date          |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------|
|                                             |              | Realisation (lower actual cost) · Explicit reassignment to another activity · No plan |                             |               |
| (illustrative example) Internal agent hours | 2,500 h/year | Reassignment to handling complex issues                                               | Customer service management | Third quarter |

Only when it is realised or reassigned in a verifiable way does it move to 7.1 as an efficiency.

### 7.4 Non-additive value and non-monetary measures (Enterprise)

| Type                                      | Description | Translated into money? | Formula or reason why it could not be quantified |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Avoided risk · Compliance · Other measure |             | Yes · No               |                                                  |

Avoided risk and compliance are not added to the net value unless they are translated into money with a formula (rule 7).

# Stop criteria

| #                       | Criterion                       | Indicator and threshold                            | Evaluation point | Decision if triggered         | Who evaluates it                   |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1                       |                                 |                                                    |                  | Stop · Pivot · Iterate        |                                    |
| 2                       |                                 |                                                    |                  |                               |                                    |
| (illustrative example)1 | Insufficient resolution         | Resolution rate < 20% after 8 weeks of pilot       | End of the pilot | Stop                          | AI Committee                       |
| (illustrative example)2 | Deterioration of the experience | Satisfaction < 73 points for two consecutive weeks | Weekly           | Suspend the pilot and Iterate | Product owner; the sponsor decides |

They must include, at a minimum, one criterion on the main metric, one on the safeguard and one economic criterion (maximum cost or investment).

# Transform only

## 9.1 Learning milestones and investment limit per stage

| Stage | Learning question | Expected evidence | Metric and threshold | Date | Maximum investment for the stage (€) | Maximum cumulative investment (€) | Decision at close      | Body |
|-------|-------------------|-------------------|----------------------|------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------|------|
| 1     |                   |                   |                      |      |                                      |                                   | Proceed · Pivot · Stop |      |
| 2     |                   |                   |                      |      |                                      |                                   |                        |      |

| Stage                           | Learning question                                                 | Expected evidence                      | Metric and threshold               | Date       | Maximum investment for the stage (€) | Maximum cumulative investment (€) | Decision at close                | Body         |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------|------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------|
| <b>(illustrative example) 1</b> | Would business customers pay for a stock-out forecasting service? | Letters of intent from pilot customers | ≥ 5 customers with signed intent   | 31-03-2027 | 60,000                               | 60,000                            | Proceed if achieved; Stop if not | AI Committee |
| <b>(illustrative example) 2</b> | Is paid use sustained?                                            | Paid trial contracts                   | ≥ 3 customers renew after 3 months | 30-09-2027 | 150,000                              | 210,000                           | Proceed · Pivot · Stop           | Board        |

## 9.2 Approval of the bet

| Field                         | Content | Guidance                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Return hypothesis</b>      |         | What revenue, services or change in operating model are expected, and when.                      |
| <b>Main uncertainties</b>     |         | What is not yet known and will be resolved with the milestones.                                  |
| <b>Option value</b>           |         | What capability or position the company gains even if the bet does not scale. Documented for G3. |
| <b>Total investment limit</b> |         | Maximum authorised before a new board decision.                                                  |
| <b>Board decision</b>         |         | Date, body and reference of the minutes.                                                         |

## 10

# Check by ambition level at G2

Reference: 01 §7.6.

| Level           | What the canvas must contain                                        | Met                       |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Optimise</b> | Baseline for cost, time or errors; expected savings with a formula. | Yes · No · Not applicable |

| Level            | What the canvas must contain                                                            | Met |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| <b>Augment</b>   | Performance and cost metrics; adoption target.                                          |     |
| <b>Transform</b> | Return hypothesis with learning milestones; investment limit per stage; board approval. |     |

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## Quality criteria

The formal G2 criteria are in document 21 (see criteria G2.xx).

| # | Check                                                                                         | Status                                   |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 1 | The hypothesis is falsifiable: it has a refutation condition, threshold, scope and timeframe. | Met · Not met · Not applicable · Pending |
| 2 | The baseline is measured or its estimate is justified in P09.                                 |                                          |
| 3 | There is a main metric and at least one safeguard metric.                                     |                                          |
| 4 | The attribution method is explicit and controls the main threats.                             |                                          |
| 5 | Every amount has a formula, type and status.                                                  |                                          |
| 6 | Released capacity is shown separately and does not count.                                     |                                          |
| 7 | Annual net value and additional net value per euro are calculated.                            |                                          |
| 8 | The stop criteria exist and predate the investment.                                           |                                          |
| 9 | For Transform: milestones, limit per stage, option value and board approval.                  |                                          |

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## Approval and verification

| Function        | Role in SEVEN-G  | Name and position | Date | Signature or reference |
|-----------------|------------------|-------------------|------|------------------------|
| <b>Prepares</b> | AI Product Owner |                   |      |                        |

| Function            | Role in SEVEN-G                               | Name and position | Date | Signature or reference |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------|------|------------------------|
| Reviews unit values | Management control                            |                   |      |                        |
| Verifies            | AI Office (Lite) · AI Auditor (Enterprise)    |                   |      |                        |
| Decides             | AI Sponsor (Lite) · AI Committee (Enterprise) |                   |      |                        |
| Approves Transform  | Board or board committee                      |                   |      |                        |

Segregation of duties: the verifier has not prepared the canvas; the sponsor is accountable for the value, but does not verify.

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## Version control

### Completed document

| Version | Date | Author | Changes |
|---------|------|--------|---------|
|---------|------|--------|---------|

### Template

| Version | Date       | Changes                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0.1     | 16-09-2026 | First version. Applies the measurement rules in 00 §6, the G2 criteria by ambition level in 01 §7.6 and the value parameters in the common specification §5.7. |